

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd.

Employee Handbook & Internal Policy Manual

Version 3.2 | Effective Date: January 1, 2025

Classification: Internal Use Only

Human Resources Department

Kathmandu, Nepal

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1. Company Overview

NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. is a Kathmandu-based software and IT services company founded in 2014. The company provides enterprise software development, cloud infrastructure management, and digital transformation consulting to clients across South Asia, the Middle East, and Europe.

1.1 Mission & Values

Our mission is to deliver technology solutions that empower businesses to operate smarter, scale faster, and serve their customers better. We are guided by the following core values:

- Integrity: We act with honesty and transparency in all interactions with clients, partners, and each other.
- Innovation: We continuously seek better ways to solve problems.
- Accountability: We take ownership of our commitments and outcomes.
- Inclusion: We foster a workplace where every voice is heard and valued.
- Excellence: We hold ourselves to the highest professional standards.

1.2 Organizational Structure

NovaTech is organized into the following business units:

Department	Primary Responsibilities
Engineering	Software development, QA, DevOps, and infrastructure
Product	Product strategy, roadmaps, and UX/UI design
Sales & BD	Client acquisition, partnerships, and account management
Human Resources	Recruitment, employee relations, and compliance
Finance	Budgeting, payroll, invoicing, and financial reporting
Legal & Compliance	Contracts, regulatory compliance, and IP management
Marketing	Brand, content, digital campaigns, and events

2. Employment Policies

2.1 Equal Opportunity Employment

NovaTech Solutions is an equal opportunity employer. We do not discriminate on the basis of race, caste, ethnicity, religion, gender, sexual orientation, disability, age, or any other characteristic protected by applicable law. All hiring, promotion, and termination decisions are made solely on the basis of qualifications, performance, and business need.

2.2 Probation Period

All new employees are subject to a probation period of 90 calendar days from their start date. During this period:

- Either party may terminate employment with 7 days' written notice.
- Performance evaluations will be conducted at Day 30 and Day 75.
- Employees are eligible for employee benefits from Day 1, with the exception of annual leave accrual, which begins after successful completion of probation.

2.3 Working Hours

Standard working hours at NovaTech are as follows:

Employment Type	Standard Hours	Flexibility
Full-Time (On-site)	9:00 AM – 6:00 PM, Sun–Thu	Core hours: 10 AM – 4 PM
Full-Time (Remote)	40 hours/week	Flexible, team availability required
Part-Time	As per contract	Agreed with line manager
Contract / Freelance	As per SOW	Deliverable-based

Note: Employees working on international client projects may be required to observe adjusted hours to accommodate time zone differences. Any such arrangement must be approved in writing by the employee's line manager and HR.

2.4 Remote Work Policy

NovaTech supports a hybrid work model. Employees may request to work remotely for up to 3 days per week, subject to the following conditions:

- The employee has completed their probation period.
- The employee maintains full availability on communication channels (Slack, email) during core hours.
- The employee's role does not require mandatory on-site presence (e.g., hardware lab, reception).
- Remote work approval is granted by the line manager and is not a contractual right.

Employees working fully remote must participate in at least one on-site visit per quarter at their own arrangement, unless they are located outside the Kathmandu Valley.

3. Leave Policies

3.1 Leave Entitlement Summary

Leave Type	Days/Year	Key Conditions
Annual Leave	18 days	Accrues monthly; up to 9 days carry-forward
Sick Leave	12 days	Medical certificate required after 3 consecutive days
Maternity Leave	98 days	As per Labor Act 2074; 60 days fully paid
Paternity Leave	15 days	Must be taken within 3 months of child's birth
Bereavement Leave	5 days	Immediate family; extended family: 3 days
Public Holidays	13 days	Per Government of Nepal gazette
Emergency Leave	3 days	Unpaid; manager pre-approval required
Study / Exam Leave	5 days	Supporting documents required

3.2 Leave Application Process

1. Log in to the NovaTech HR Portal (hr.novatech.com.np).
2. Navigate to Leave Management > Apply Leave.
3. Select leave type, dates, and provide a reason.
4. Submit the request at least 3 working days in advance (except emergency/sick leave).
5. Your line manager will approve or decline within 1 working day.
6. A calendar notification will be sent to your team automatically upon approval.

4. Code of Conduct

4.1 Professional Conduct

All NovaTech employees are expected to maintain professional standards in their interactions with colleagues, clients, vendors, and the public. This includes:

- Treating all individuals with respect and courtesy.
- Maintaining punctuality and meeting commitments.
- Avoiding gossip, rumor-spreading, or divisive behavior.
- Representing the company positively in external settings.

4.2 Anti-Harassment & Anti-Discrimination

NovaTech has a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, bullying, and discrimination of any kind. Harassment includes, but is not limited to:

- Verbal or written abuse, threats, or demeaning comments.
- Unwelcome physical contact or gestures.
- Sharing or displaying offensive material in the workplace or on digital platforms.
- Retaliation against anyone who reports a harassment complaint in good faith.

Employees who experience or witness harassment should report it immediately to HR (hr@novatech.com.np) or to the designated Grievance Officer. All complaints will be investigated confidentially and resolved within 15 working days.

4.3 Conflict of Interest

Employees must disclose any actual or potential conflict of interest to HR and their line manager. A conflict of interest arises when personal interests could improperly influence professional decisions. Common examples include:

- Owning a financial interest in a competing business.
- Hiring or supervising a close family member.
- Accepting gifts valued above NPR 5,000 from vendors or clients.
- Conducting personal business using company resources.

4.4 Social Media Policy

Employees may use personal social media accounts freely in their personal capacity. However:

- Do not disclose confidential company or client information on any platform.
- Do not post content that could be construed as official company communication without prior approval from Marketing.
- Do not make disparaging remarks about the company, colleagues, or clients online.
- When in doubt, add a disclaimer: "Views are my own and do not represent NovaTech Solutions."

5. Data Security & IT Usage Policy

5.1 Acceptable Use of Company Systems

Company-provided devices, software, and network infrastructure are to be used primarily for business purposes. Incidental personal use is permitted provided it does not:

- Consume excessive bandwidth or storage.
- Compromise device or network security.
- Violate any other provision of this policy.

5.2 Password & Access Management

All employees must adhere to the following password standards:

- Minimum 12 characters, including uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and symbols.
- Passwords must not be shared with anyone, including IT staff.
- Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for all company accounts.
- Passwords must be rotated every 90 days or immediately upon suspected compromise.

Important: The IT department will never ask for your password via email or phone. Any such request should be reported immediately to it-security@novatech.com.np.

5.3 Data Classification

All company data is classified into one of four tiers:

Classification	Examples	Handling Requirements
Public	Press releases, marketing materials	No restrictions
Internal	Project plans, internal memos	NovaTech employees only
Confidential	Client data, source code, financials	Need-to-know basis; encrypted storage
Restricted	PII, credentials, legal documents	Strict access control; encryption mandatory

5.4 Incident Reporting

Any suspected data breach, unauthorized access, or security incident must be reported to the IT Security team within 2 hours of discovery. Do not attempt to investigate or remediate the incident independently. Include the following in your report:

- Date and time of discovery
- Systems or data potentially affected
- Actions already taken (if any)
- Name and contact information of the person reporting

6. Performance Management & Compensation

6.1 Performance Review Cycle

NovaTech conducts structured performance reviews on the following schedule:

- Mid-Year Check-In (June): Informal review; goal tracking and feedback session.
- Annual Review (December): Formal evaluation covering KPIs, competencies, and development goals.
- Probation Review: At Day 30 and Day 75 for all new employees.

6.2 Salary Structure & Increments

Compensation at NovaTech is benchmarked against market data from industry surveys conducted annually. Salary increments are performance-linked:

Performance Rating	Increment Range	Bonus Eligibility
Exceptional (5)	15% – 20%	Yes – Up to 2 months' salary
Exceeds Expectations (4)	10% – 14%	Yes – Up to 1 month's salary
Meets Expectations (3)	6% – 9%	Yes – Up to 2 weeks' salary
Needs Improvement (2)	0% – 5%	No
Unsatisfactory (1)	0%	No; PIP may be initiated

6.3 Benefits

NovaTech provides the following benefits to all permanent full-time employees:

- Provident Fund: 10% employee contribution matched by 10% employer contribution.
- Medical Insurance: Coverage up to NPR 500,000/year per employee; family floater option available.
- Accidental Insurance: Coverage up to NPR 1,000,000.
- Internet Allowance: NPR 2,000/month for remote employees.
- Training Budget: NPR 30,000/year for approved courses, certifications, or conferences.
- Device Allowance: Company laptop provided; mobile device allowance for senior roles.

7. Grievance & Disciplinary Procedures

7.1 Grievance Procedure

Employees who have a work-related complaint or grievance should follow this process:

7. Informal Resolution: Discuss the issue directly with the person involved or your line manager within 5 working days of the incident.
8. Formal Grievance: If unresolved, submit a written grievance to HR within 10 working days.
9. Investigation: HR will assign a neutral investigator within 3 working days of receipt.
10. Resolution: A written outcome will be provided within 15 working days of formal filing.
11. Appeal: If unsatisfied, the employee may appeal to the CEO within 5 working days of the resolution.

7.2 Disciplinary Action Framework

Disciplinary actions are graduated based on severity and frequency of misconduct:

- Verbal Warning: For minor, first-time infractions.
- Written Warning: For repeated minor infractions or moderate misconduct.
- Final Written Warning / Suspension: For serious misconduct or repeated violations.
- Termination: For gross misconduct or failure to improve after Final Warning.

Examples of gross misconduct warranting immediate termination include: theft, fraud, physical assault, serious data breach, or bringing the company into disrepute.

7.3 Separation Policy

When an employment relationship ends, the following applies:

- Voluntary Resignation: Employee must provide 30 days' written notice (60 days for senior management roles).
- Termination by Company: NovaTech will provide 30 days' notice or equivalent pay in lieu.
- Exit Interview: All departing employees will be invited to a confidential exit interview with HR.
- Full & Final Settlement: All dues (salary, leave encashment, PF) will be processed within 30 days of the last working day.
- Return of Assets: All company property must be returned on or before the last working day.

8. Health, Safety & Wellbeing

8.1 Workplace Safety

NovaTech is committed to maintaining a safe and healthy work environment. All employees are expected to:

- Report unsafe conditions to Facilities Management immediately.
- Follow fire safety and emergency evacuation procedures (posted at each exit).
- Not engage in behaviors that endanger themselves or colleagues.
- Participate in mandatory safety briefings held quarterly.

8.2 Mental Health & Wellbeing

NovaTech recognizes that mental health is as important as physical health. We offer the following:

- Employee Assistance Program (EAP): Free, confidential counseling sessions (up to 6 per year).
- Flexible Scheduling: For employees managing mental health challenges, temporary flexible arrangements can be requested.
- Wellbeing Leave: Employees may use sick leave for mental health days without additional justification.
- Peer Support Groups: Opt-in peer support channels are available on Slack (#wellbeing).

8.3 Alcohol & Substance Policy

Employees must not be under the influence of alcohol or illegal substances during working hours, on company premises, or at company-sponsored events. Employees found to be in violation may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

9. Intellectual Property & Confidentiality

9.1 Ownership of Work Product

All work created by employees in the course of their employment — including software, code, designs, documentation, reports, and any other deliverables — is the sole and exclusive property of NovaTech Solutions Pvt. Ltd. This applies regardless of whether the work was created during or outside business hours, if it used company resources.

9.2 Confidentiality Obligations

Employees have a duty to protect confidential information during and after their employment. This obligation covers:

- Client names, contracts, and project details.
- Proprietary technology, source code, and trade secrets.
- Business strategies, pricing, and financial data.
- Personal data of employees, clients, or partners.

Employees are required to sign the NovaTech Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA) prior to their first day of work. Breaches of confidentiality may result in disciplinary action and legal proceedings.

9.3 Open Source Usage

Employees working with or integrating open source software must:

- Verify that the license is compatible with commercial use (e.g., MIT, Apache 2.0).
- Document all third-party libraries used in project repositories.
- Obtain Legal team approval before incorporating GPL-licensed code into any product.
- Never publish proprietary company code to public repositories without written authorization.

10. Policy Acknowledgement

By signing below, I confirm that I have read, understood, and agree to comply with the NovaTech Solutions Employee Handbook & Internal Policy Manual (Version 3.2). I understand that failure to comply with these policies may result in disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment.

Employee Full Name:

Signature:

Employee ID:

Date:

Department:

Manager Signature:

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